

## Reporting Verbs Used with All Forms of Optative Sentences

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### Reporting Verbs

An **optative sentence** expresses a **wish, prayer, blessing, curse, hope, desire, or good/bad intention**.

Common markers include:

- . **May...!**
- . **May God...!**
- . **Would that...!**
- . **If only...!**
- . **Long live...!**
- . **Heaven help...!**
- . **God bless...!**
- . **May you...!**
- . **May you never...!**

1. **Wish** — □□□□□ / □□□□□

When someone expresses an ordinary wish or desire.

| Reporting Verb   | Nepali Meaning    |
|------------------|-------------------|
| wished           | □□□□□ / □□□□□ □□□ |
| desired          | □□□□□ □□□         |
| expressed a wish | □□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□  |
| longed           | □□□□□ □□□□□ □□□   |

### Example

**Direct:** He said, “May I succeed!”

**Indirect:** He **wished** that he might succeed.

**Nepali:** □□□□ □□□ □□□ □□□□ □□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□□

## 2. Good Wish — □□□□□□□□

Used when the speaker wishes something good for another person.

| Reporting Verb          | Nepali Meaning      |
|-------------------------|---------------------|
| wished                  | □□□□□□□□ □□□        |
| bestowed good wishes on | □□□□□□□□ □□□        |
| expressed good wishes   | □□□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□ |

## Example

**Direct:** She said to me, “May you succeed in life!”

**Indirect:** She **wished that I might succeed** in life.

**Nepali:** □□□□ □ □□□□□□ □□□ □□□□ □□□□ □□□□□□□□ □□□□□□

## 3. Blessing — □□□□□□□□

When an elder, parent, teacher, priest, or respected person wishes someone well.

| Reporting Verb                | Nepali Meaning       |
|-------------------------------|----------------------|
| <b>blessed</b>                | □□□□□□□□ □□□         |
| <b>prayed for</b>             | □□□□□□□□□□ □□□       |
| <b>wished</b>                 | □□□□□□□□ □□□         |
| <b>invoked blessings upon</b> | □□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□ □□□ |

## Example

**Direct:** The grandmother said, “May God bless you!”

**Indirect:** The grandmother **blessed me and prayed that God might bless** me.

**Nepali:** □□□□□□□□ □□□□ □□□□□□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□□□□ □□□□  
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## Another example

**Direct:** Father said to his son, “May you live long!”

**Indirect:** Father **blessed his son that he might live long.**

In natural English, **blessed his son and wished that he might live long** is often smoother than *blessed him that....*

## 4. Prayer — □□□□□□□□□□

When the wish is addressed to God or a divine power.

| Reporting Verb       | Nepali Meaning                |
|----------------------|-------------------------------|
| <b>prayed</b>        | □□□□□□□□□□ □□□                |
| <b>prayed to God</b> | □□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□ □□□     |
| <b>invoked</b>       | □□□□□□□ / □□□□□□□□□□ □□□      |
| <b>beseached</b>     | □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□ □□□ |
| <b>entreated</b>     | □□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□ □□□          |

## Example

**Direct:** He said, “May God help the poor!”

**Indirect:** He **prayed that God might help** the poor.

**Nepali:** □□□□ □□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□  
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## 5. Curse — □□□□□□ / □□□□□□□

When someone wishes something bad to happen to another person.

| Reporting Verb            | Nepali Meaning                  |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------|
| <b>cursed</b>             | □□□□□□ □□□                      |
| <b>invoked a curse on</b> | □□□□□□ □□□/□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□ □□□ |
| <b>wished evil upon</b>   | □□□□□□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□ |

### Example

**Direct:** He said, “May you suffer for your deeds!”

**Indirect:** He **cursed him that he might suffer** for his deeds.

More natural:

He **cursed him and wished that he might suffer** for his deeds.

**Nepali:** □□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□ □□□□□□  
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## 6. Bad Wish —

A speaker may express a negative wish without it necessarily being a formal curse.

| Reporting Verb       | Nepali Meaning                    |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------|
| wished evil upon     | बुरो कुरा सोच्न (बुरो कुरा सोच्न) |
| wished harm upon     | बुरो कुरा सोच्न (बुरो कुरा सोच्न) |
| cursed               | बुरो कुरा सोच्न (बुरो कुरा सोच्न) |
| expressed a bad wish | बुरो कुरा सोच्न (बुरो कुरा सोच्न) |

## Example

**Direct:** He said, “May he never prosper!”

**Indirect: He wished that he might never prosper.**

If the intention is clearly malicious:

**He cursed him and wished that he might never prosper.**

## 7. Hope — □□□

Some optative sentences express a desired future outcome.

| Reporting Verb    | Nepali Meaning          |
|-------------------|-------------------------|
| hoped             | □□□ □□□                 |
| wished            | □□□□□ □□□               |
| desired           | □□□□□ □□□               |
| looked forward to | □□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□ □□□ |

### Example

**Direct:** He said, “May everything go well!”

**Indirect:** He **hoped** that everything might go well.

**Nepali:** □□□□ □□□ □□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□ □□□□ □□□ □□□□□□

## 8. Expressing a Strong Desire — □□□□□ □□□□□

| Reporting Verb | Nepali Meaning  |
|----------------|-----------------|
| desired        | □□□□□ □□□□□ □□□ |
| wished         | □□□□□ □□□       |
| longed         | □□□□□ □□□□□ □□□ |

|         |                 |
|---------|-----------------|
| yearned | □□□□□ □□□□□ □□□ |
| craved  | □□□□□ □□□□□ □□□ |

### Example

**Direct:** She said, “If only I could meet my old friend!”

**Indirect:** She **wished that she could meet** her old friend.

## 9. Regretful Wish — □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□

This is often expressed with **Would that...!** or **If only...!**

| Reporting Verb             | Nepali Meaning                       |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| wished                     | □□□□□ □□□                            |
| regretted                  | □□□□□ □□□                            |
| expressed a regretful wish | □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□<br>□□□□□□ □□□ |

### Example

**Direct:** He said, “If only I had studied harder!”

**Indirect:** He **wished that he had studied** harder.

**Nepali:** □□□□ □□ □□□□□ □□□□ □□□□□ □□ □□□□□□□□ □□□□ □□□□□□  
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## 10. Impossible / Unreal Wish — □□□□□□ □□ □□□□□□□□ □□□□□□

### Reporting Verb      Nepali Meaning

wished                      □□□□□□/□□□□□□ □□□

longed                      □□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□

dreamed of                □□□□□□□□/□□□□□ □□□□□

### Example

**Direct:** He said, “Would that I were rich!”

**Indirect:** He wished that he were rich.

**Nepali:** □□□□ □□□ □□□ □□□□ □□ □□□□□□□□ □□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□□□□

## 11. “Long Live...” — □□□□□□□□□□/□□□□□□□□

**Long live + person/nation/institution** expresses a strong wish for continued life, success, or existence.

| Reporting Verb                 | Nepali Meaning               |
|--------------------------------|------------------------------|
| wished                         | □□□□□□□□ □□□                 |
| expressed the wish that...     | ...□□ □□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□       |
| prayed for the long life of... | □□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□<br>□□□ |

## Example

**Direct:** The people said, “Long live our King!”

**Indirect:** The people **wished that their King might live long.**

**Nepali:** □□□□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□ □□□□

**12. “May God...” —** □□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□ □□□□□

| Expression               | Reporting Verb   |
|--------------------------|------------------|
| May God bless you!       | blessed / prayed |
| May God help you!        | prayed           |
| May God protect you!     | prayed           |
| May God forgive him!     | prayed           |
| May God grant your wish! | prayed           |

## Example

**Direct:** Mother said, “May God protect you!”

**Indirect:** Mother **prayed that God might protect** me.

13. “Heaven Help...” — □□□□ □□□□□□/□□□□□

**Heaven help him!** expresses a strong wish or warning that divine help may come.

## Reporting verbs

- **prayed**
- **hoped**
- **wished**
- **invoked divine help**

## Example

**Direct:** He said, “Heaven help us!”

**Indirect:** He **prayed that Heaven might help** them.

14. “God Bless...” — □□□□□□□□

## Example

**Direct:** The old man said, “God bless you!”

**Indirect:** The old man **blessed me and prayed that God might bless me.**

**Nepali:** □□□□□ □□□□□□□ □□□□ □□□□□□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□□□□ □□□□  
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## 15. Expressing a Hopeful Wish — □□□□□□□ □□□□□

| Reporting Verb | Nepali Meaning |
|----------------|----------------|
| hoped          | □□□ □□□        |
| wished         | □□□□□ □□□      |
| prayed         | □□□□□□□□□ □□□  |
| desired        | □□□□□ □□□      |

## Example

**Direct:** The students said, “May we pass the examination!”

**Indirect:** The students **hoped that they might pass** the examination.

## 16. Farewell / Good-Fortune Wish — □□□□□ □□ □□□□□□□□

Some expressions at parting function as optative wishes.

| Expression                     | Reporting Verb |
|--------------------------------|----------------|
| “May you have a safe journey!” | wished         |
| “May you succeed!”             | wished         |
| “Have a happy life!”           | wished         |
| “May you be happy!”            | wished         |

### Example

**Direct:** He said to me, “May you have a safe journey!”

**Indirect:** He **wished me a safe journey.**

### ☆ Master List of Optative Reporting Verbs

| Meaning          | Suitable Reporting Verbs      | Nepali                         |
|------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| <b>Wish</b>      | wished, desired, longed       | □□□□□/□□□□□ □□□                |
| <b>Good wish</b> | wished, expressed good wishes | □□□□□□□□ □□□                   |
| <b>Blessing</b>  | blessed, prayed               | □□□□□□□□<br>□□□/□□□□□□□□□□ □□□ |

|                       |                               |                                |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| <b>Prayer</b>         | prayed, beseeched, entreated  | □□□□□□□□□□ / □□□□□□<br>□□□     |
| <b>Curse</b>          | cursed, wished evil upon      | □□□□□ □□□                      |
| <b>Bad wish</b>       | wished harm/evil upon, cursed | □□□□□□□<br>□□□□□□ / □□□□□□ □□□ |
| <b>Hope</b>           | hoped, wished                 | □□□ / □□□□□□ □□□               |
| <b>Strong desire</b>  | desired, longed, yearned      | □□□□□ □□□□□ □□□                |
| <b>Regretful wish</b> | wished, regretted             | □□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□<br>□□□       |
| <b>Unreal wish</b>    | wished, dreamed of            | □□□□□□□□□ □□□□□<br>□□□         |
| <b>Long-life wish</b> | wished, prayed for long life  | □□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□<br>□□□       |
| <b>Divine help</b>    | prayed, invoked               | □□□□□□□□□□<br>□□□□□□□□□□ □□□   |
| <b>Good fortune</b>   | wished, prayed                | □□□□□□□□□ □□□                  |

## Important Structures in Indirect Speech

## **1. General Wish**

**Subject + wished + that + subject + might + V1**

“May you succeed!”

→ He **wished that I might succeed.**

## **2. Prayer**

**Subject + prayed + that + subject + might + V1**

“May God help you!”

→ He **prayed that God might help me.**

## **3. Blessing**

**Subject + blessed + object + and wished/prayed that + clause**

“May you live long!”

→ The grandmother **blessed me and wished that I might live long.**

## **4. Curse**

**Subject + cursed + object + and wished that + subject + might + V1**

“May you suffer!”

→ He **cursed him and wished that he might suffer.**

## **5. Hope**

**Subject + hoped + that + subject + might/would + V1**

“May everything be fine!”

→ She **hoped that everything might be fine.**

**6. “Long live...!”**

**Subject + wished/prayed that + subject + might live long**

“Long live our country!”

→ They **wished that their country might live long.**

### **Golden Rule for Optative Sentences**

**Do not use “ordered”, “asked”, or “told” simply because the sentence is in direct speech. Identify the type of wish first.**

**May you succeed! → wished**

**May God help us! → prayed**

**May God bless you! → blessed/prayed**

**May you suffer! → cursed**

**May everything go well! → hoped/wished**

**If only I had wings! → wished**

**Long live Nepal! → wished/prayed for the long life of Nepal**

This gives you the complete meaning-based system: **Wish → Wished | Prayer → Prayed | Blessing → Blessed | Curse → Cursed | Hope → Hoped | Strong Desire → Desired/Longed | Regret → Wished/Regretted.**